

INTRO

Literature Review and Nearest Work

Prior work reads deal tone, strategy vocabulary, and prices. The missing cell is uncertainty in CEO Q&A before unannounced cash acquisitions.

WHAT THE CLOSEST WORK READS

TONE	Thewissen et al. 2024	Scripted press-release tone before stock-for-stock acquisitions.
VOCABULARY	Ragozzino & Reuer 2024	Corporate-strategy vocabulary on earnings calls around deal activity.
PRICES	Keown & Pinkerton 1981	Abnormal stock-price run-up before public merger announcements.

THIS THESIS

Uncertainty in
unscripted CEO Q&A

Uncertainty, not tone.

Q&A answers, not press releases.

Language, not prices.

POSITIONING CLAIM

No prior work occupies this exact cell.